

SERVING PLAN 2 SERVING PLAN

Fried Sesame Fish

with Black Vinegar Shiitake Mushrooms and Sticky Rice

Tonight we're trying a technique called velveting—where meat (we're using tilapia) is coated in a cornstarch mixture and quickly fried, creating a tender, moist interior with a golden, crisp exterior. It's a popular cooking method in Chinese cuisine, and those robust flavors are featured here. The sauce bathing each mushroom is tangy, salty, and sweet, balanced by the light-as-air tilapia and a bed of sticky rice.

35–45 minutes 640 calories per serving

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Ingredients

½ cup sticky rice
6 ounces cremini mushrooms
6 ounces shiitake mushrooms
2 scallions
2 cloves garlic
2 packets gluten-free soy sauce
1 tablespoon sugar
1 tablespoon black vinegar
2 tablespoons cornstarch
1 tablespoon toasted sesame seeds
10 ounces tilapia

You'll need

canola oil
kosher salt
black pepper
6" small pot with lid
12" large pan
10" medium nonstick pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

To achieve a picture-perfect golden sear on your tilapia, be sure it's very dry—removing excess moisture with a paper towel will help the cornstarch stick to it in a thin layer, creating an evenly browned crust in the pan.

Pouring oil or melted fat down the drain might damage your pipes. Instead, pour it into a heatproof container or bottle once it's cooled slightly, and dispose in the garbage.

USDA recommends cooking fish to 145°F.

Questions? Email help@plated.com or call 855-525-2399. Visit plated.me/allergens for more information on dietary restrictions.

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1. Cook rice

In a small pot, combine **rice**, **1 cup water**, and **¼ teaspoon salt** and bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to low, then cover pot and cook until water is fully absorbed, 12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Fluff **rice** with a fork, then cover again to keep warm until ready to serve.



2. Prepare ingredients

While rice cooks, wipe **cremini mushrooms** clean with a damp paper towel and cut into ¼-inch slices. Remove and discard **shiitake mushroom** stems, then wipe caps clean with a damp paper towel. Rinse **scallions**. Trim and discard **scallion** roots, halve lengthwise, then slice crosswise into 1-inch pieces, keeping **whites and light greens** separate from **dark greens**. Mince **garlic**.



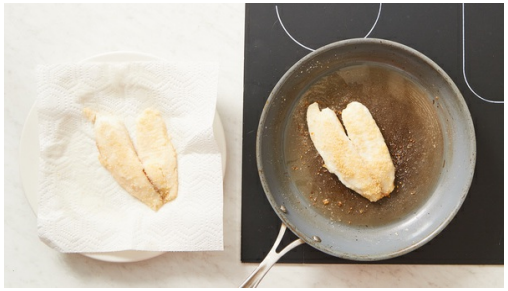
3. Sauté mushrooms

Heat **1½ tablespoons canola oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **cremini mushrooms**, **shiitake mushrooms**, and **scallion whites and light greens** and sauté, stirring, until mushrooms are tender and just golden, 7–9 minutes. Stir in **soy sauce**, **sugar**, **black vinegar**, **garlic**, and **¼ cup water** and simmer until reduced by half, 2–3 minutes more. Remove pan from heat.



4. Dredge fish

While mushrooms sauté, on a large plate, combine **cornstarch** and **half of sesame seeds**. Pat **tilapia** very dry with paper towel and season all over with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired (see recipe tip). Dredge **tilapia** in **cornstarch mixture**, pressing to adhere.



5. Fry fish

Heat **3 tablespoons canola oil** in a medium nonstick pan over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, carefully add **tilapia**, standing back in case hot oil splatters, and fry, working in batches and adding more oil as needed, until fish is cooked through and crust is golden, 3–5 minutes per side. Transfer **tilapia** to a paper towel–lined plate to drain (see recipe tip).



6. Plate fried sesame fish

Divide **sticky rice** between serving plates. Top with **black vinegar shiitake mushrooms**, then **fried sesame fish**. Garnish with **scallion dark greens** and **remaining sesame seeds**. Dig in!

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